

Paying for Tools per Request

An agent that needs one answer should be able to buy one answer. This sample report describes how a tool server can price each call, ask for payment in the HTTP 402 response, and serve the result once the payment is proven. No account is created and no key is shared.

The buyer sends a request and receives a price. It signs a payment for that exact amount and sends the request again. The server checks the signature, runs the tool, and settles the payment only when the tool succeeded. A failed call is never charged.

How a Price Is Chosen

Most tools are deterministic code with a fixed price per call.

Model-backed tools are metered: the server quotes a ceiling first and charges the measured usage, never more than the quote.

Prices are published in a machine-readable catalog so an agent can compare tools before it calls one. The same catalog lists which payment networks each tool accepts.

What the Buyer Keeps

Every paid answer carries a receipt that names the payment, so a buyer can match its spending to the calls it made. A retry with the same idempotency key returns the first answer instead of paying twice. This page closes the sample report.